

IGOR TRON

Senior PHP & WordPress Developer

CONTACTS

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LINKS

[github](#) [wordpress](#)

LOCATION

Tbilisi, Georgia
Available for remote
B2B/contract work with US
time-zone overlap

SUMMARY

Senior **PHP** and **WordPress** developer with 15+ years of experience building everything from simple marketing sites to complex, high-traffic platforms on top of WordPress. Strong focus on performance, scalable architecture, editor experience, CI/CD, and **development workflows powered by AI coding agents such as Codex and Claude Code**. Led WordPress platform development for media and enterprise clients, including performance optimization, database refactoring, automation, and technical leadership of small engineering teams.

WORK EXPERIENCE

COINTELEGRAPH – Lead WordPress Engineer

New York, United States
2023 – 2025

EXPERTISE & RESPONSIBILITIES

- Led architecture for a shared WordPress platform powering dozens of related sites from a single codebase, reducing duplication and making long-term maintenance more predictable.
- Organized and led a small development team, including task planning, mentoring, code reviews, and technical debt management.
- Improved performance and reliability of high-traffic WordPress platforms through database query optimization, Cloudflare caching, S3 static asset offloading, MySQL replication, and Elasticsearch/Algolia search integration.
- Leading frontend performance optimization initiatives for WordPress projects, improving FCP, LCP, CLS, and Speed Index through asset bundling, caching/CDN tuning, offloading static assets to Amazon S3, splitting CSS into critical and deferred parts, and stabilizing layouts for a more consistent UX.

SKILLS

AI Agents
AI Prompt Engineering
GPT Codex
Claude Code
Workflow Automation

WordPress Unit Tests
WordPress hooks
WordPress Gutenberg
WP CLI
WP Multisite

PHP7 PHP8 PHPUnit WordPress Unit
Tests Composer Docker xDebug
MySQL Elasticsearch Algolia
WebSocket REST API
GitFlow GitHub Actions CI/CD NGINX
CloudFlare Amazon S3
Javascript jQuery HTML5 CSS3 CSS
Preprocessors Webpack React Native
Core Web Vitals
PHPSC PSR WPCS

TDD EDA OOP GRASP SOLID

EDUCATION

Moscow Government Social University
Moscow, Russia

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built reusable AI-agent workflows for WordPress development, **reducing delivery time** for repeatable project setup and implementation tasks **from 10+ days to 1-2 days**.
- Optimized a high-traffic WordPress site for a crypto media outlet by refactoring database and backend queries, fine-tuning Cloudflare caching rules and moving to a cloud-based architecture, which significantly improved **frontend performance and fault tolerance** under heavy load.
- Built a WordPress-based framework for **rapid development and long-term maintenance** of both standalone landing pages and more complex integrated projects.
- Delivered several projects with automatically updated content based on fully automated and semi-automated data import pipelines.
- Designed a user-friendly, editor-focused WordPress admin interface, which noticeably improved the **efficiency and comfort of daily work for content managers**.
- Implemented a role- and capability-based security model for the WordPress admin area, combined with hardened CI/CD workflows, strict file permissions and opinionated WordPress configuration, **effectively reducing the risk** of unauthorized or accidental harmful actions to near zero.

EPAM Systems – PHP Software Engineer

Moscow, Russia
Herceg-Novi, Montenegro

2021 – 2023

EXPERTISE & RESPONSIBILITIES

- Developed custom WordPress themes, plugins, and drop-ins for various clients such as **Bacardi** and **Thomson Reuters**, increasing website functionality and user engagement.
- Optimized PHP and WordPress performance by implementing object and page caching, database query optimization, and Algolia

search services.

- Extended and customized the WordPress REST API and implemented custom endpoints to meet specific client requirements.
- Participated in WordPress events and contributed to open-source plugins, demonstrating a long-term commitment to the WordPress community and the open-source ecosystem.

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Optimized and deeply refactored database queries, resulting in up to **250% faster** WordPress admin performance and up to **400% faster** processing of unauthenticated requests on client sites.
- Developed a WordPress extension that introduces new types of relationships between core entities using custom database tables, greatly **simplifying the codebase** and **reducing the cost** of database operations.

Freelance Developer – PHP & WordPress specialist

Worldwide

2009 – 2021

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Migrated a blog with hundreds of posts and their comments from LiveJournal to WordPress, preserving content structure, discussion threads, media and SEO as much as possible.
- Migrated a publishing house website from Django to WordPress, modelling non-standard data types and relationships with custom post types, taxonomies and custom tables, with the original database containing tens of thousands of records.
- Built and launched hundreds of WordPress-based landing pages and corporate websites over the years, from simple promo pages to more complex marketing sites.
- Promoted a test-driven mindset and introduced PHPUnit and WPUnit test suites for WordPress projects, enabling earlier detection of bugs at the automated tests stage.